

Slippery pitch

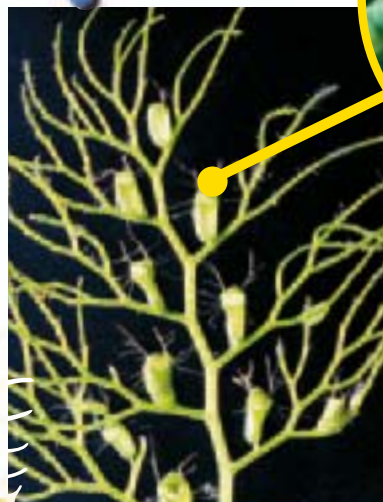
The pitcher plant can catch loads of insects inside its huge leaves. The insects can't climb out of the waxy leaves, and they drown in the liquid at the bottom of the deep pit.



The pitcher's walls are thin so the plant can absorb the nutrients from the insects.

Meaty facts

- Most carnivorous plants live in marshy areas where the earth alone does not provide enough nutrients.
- The biggest carnivorous plant – a kind of pitcher – has vines up to 10 m (33 ft) long. It can catch frogs!



Watch out!

The rim of the pitcher is coloured to attract insects – and slippery so they fall in.

The sundew acts just like flypaper.

Sticky business

An unfortunate fly lands for a moment on a sundew fly trap... and remains stuck fast. The leaves are covered in sticky hairs that trap the insect, ready for eating later.

There is no way a fly can free itself from the many sticky hairs.



The bladder is full of hairs that sense prey.

Tiny trapdoors

When prey floats past this underwater bladderwort, the bladders on the leaves quickly open, like a mouth, sucking the insect inside. It takes one-thousandth of a second to trap the prey.

The leaf curls around the fly to bring it towards the digestion cells.

Any bits of fly that the plant doesn't digest are left stuck to the leaf.